Divided Vietnam

In 1957, Vietnam was officially separated into two nations: South Vietnam and North Vietnam. South Vietnam was ruled by an emperor who was supported by France. North Vietnam was under the control of Ho Chi Minh, as recognized by the Geneva Accords. A temporary demilitarized zone was established at the 17th parallel to help stop the fighting for the time being. Furthermore, a free election was scheduled to reunite the country in 1956.